



Luke Michaels

Designer, Developer & Video Editor

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SUMMARY

Designer, developer, and video editor with 15+ years taking work from idea to finished product. I research and design interfaces, build them in React and WordPress, and produce the graphics, motion, and video that go around them. Most of my career has been agency and nonprofit campaign work, shipping on deadline for teams that needed the result to hold up. Accessibility, performance, and systems other people can run without me are constants in how I work.

SKILLS

Web Development: HTML5, CSS3/Sass, JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, React, Next.js, WordPress (custom themes, ACF Pro, Gutenberg), PHP, Node.js, Git/GitHub, Core Web Vitals and performance, WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility

UX/UI Design: User research, usability testing, stakeholder interviews, journey mapping, wireframing, interaction design, high-fidelity prototyping in Figma, design systems and component libraries

Graphic Design: Brand identity, typography, color, layout, visual hierarchy, print advertisements and collateral, social creative, print production and color management (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign)

Video & Motion: Editing in Premiere Pro and Final Cut Pro, footage assembly, sound and music, short-form and social video, motion graphics and title effects in After Effects

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Freelance Web Designer & Developer
Self-employed | 2025 to Present | Remote
Current contract: designing and building the website for Voters For Animal Rights (vfar.org), a fixed-scope WordPress project I run end to end, from discovery and design through development and launch.

Senior Web Developer & UX Designer

Mercy For Animals

09/17 to 11/25 | Remote / Portland, OR

Owned design, front-end development, and campaign media for a global advocacy nonprofit reaching millions of visitors a year, working across product, content, and program teams.

- Built and maintained a 100+ component design system and ACF Pro block library, with contribution standards and documentation, so 20+ non-technical staff could assemble campaign sites without a developer. Launches dropped from two weeks to three days.
- Raised Core Web Vitals by up to 40% and moved mobile PageSpeed from the 60s into the 90s through code-splitting, asset optimization, and caching.
- Took public-facing properties to WCAG 2.1 AA and 95%+ Lighthouse accessibility scores with semantic markup, keyboard and focus handling, ARIA, and screen-reader testing.
- Ran usability tests and stakeholder interviews, then turned the findings into design patterns and components the team reused across campaigns.
- Designed campaign creative across web, social, email, and print, holding brand consistency across every surface.
- Edited short-form documentary-style video from footage to final cut, and built motion text and title effects in After Effects.
- Shipped A/B-test-ready CTA components deployed across international campaigns, cutting deployment time about 50% and bounce rates 15 to 20% on key pages.

Front-End Developer & UX Designer

DHX Advertising

02/16 to 09/17 | Portland, OR

- Built responsive WordPress and Drupal sites from mockups for regional and national marketing clients, with reusable components and CSS animation.
- Designed brand-consistent marketing creative, and edited a client marketing video from footage to final cut.

Web Designer & Front-End Developer

Needmore Designs

11/15 to 02/16 | Portland, OR

- Designed and built accessible sites for boutique brands, with CMS setups non-technical owners could manage themselves.

Web Designer & Developer

Conscious Box

10/13 to 11/15 | Portland, OR

- Designed marketing pages, subscription onboarding, and email campaigns, and A/B-tested landing pages that raised conversion.
- Kept the brand consistent across web, print, email, and social.

Web Designer & Developer

Bob's Red Mill Natural Foods

04/11 to 10/13 | Milwaukie, OR

- Maintained and extended ecommerce across Magento, WooCommerce, and custom PHP for a high-volume consumer audience.
- Reworked navigation and checkout, and worked on SEO, server administration, and site performance.

Earlier Roles (2005 to 2011):

Web design, front-end development, motion and Flash animation, print layouts, and brand assets at agencies including Off The Wall Media, Print Time, LineDrive, and Title Boxing.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Night Lights (nightlights.club) | Headless WordPress/WooCommerce, React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind

Ecommerce shop for my handmade interactive LED art and DIY kits. I designed the brand, built the store, and shipped the whole thing myself.

Personal Portfolio & Dashboard

(lukemichaels.com) | React, Framer Motion

Component-based portfolio built end to end, with a 100/100 Lighthouse performance score.

EDUCATION

A.S. in Computer Science & Digital Media

Full Sail University | Orlando, FL

